Claim × Witness Map

An epistemic framework for assessing claims, evidence, and sources.

Companion paper: Two Instruments, One Epistemic Picture

A companion to the Claim Matrix and the Witness Matrix · v1.0 · 25 October 2026

A persuasive account presents several things at once: something is said to have happened, a reason is offered for believing it, and a person or system speaks with some degree of certainty. In ordinary conversation these can merge. A confident speaker may sound like strong evidence; a doubtful speaker may seem to weaken an otherwise sound account.

The two matrices make these questions visible. The **Claim Matrix** locates a claim by its type and the checking behind it. The **Witness Matrix** locates its source by credibility for the task and the confidence expressed. Together they offer a shared vocabulary for an initial assessment and the next useful check.

The sheets are designed to be read at a glance. Their second pages explain the axes and markers. This companion develops the relationship between the instruments and shows how to use them without turning the coloured cells into a substitute for judgment.

1. Begin with the claim

Write down what is actually being asserted. Preserve its scope: who, what, where, and when, as far as the account specifies them. “The visible side of the house is white” is different from “the entire house is white.” Certainty about the first does not establish the second.

Choose the lane by the kind of claim:

- **Lane A: observation.** “I saw it,” “the meter read this,” or “the document states that.” This is a reported observation, not a guarantee of accurate perception or reporting.
- **Lane B: inference.** “Therefore this happened,” or “this pattern indicates that.” The conclusion depends on premises and reasoning that should be made inspectable.
- **Lane C: scenario.** “Imagine if,” “suppose that,” or an explicitly hypothetical alternative. It explores possibilities; it does not report that the imagined event occurred.

A sentence can contain more than one lane. “The invoice exceeds the order, so we were overcharged” combines a claim about recorded amounts with a conclusion about what was owed. Split them when that distinction affects the assessment.

Observation and inference are different kinds of work, not a hierarchy of truth. An inference may be well supported while an apparent observation is mistaken. A scenario may be useful while remaining hypothetical. Check its factual assumptions or predictions as separate A or B claims.

2. Separate the check from its result

The Evidence Grade describes what checking is available: **EG-0**, an account alone; **EG-1**, an inspectable record or reasoning; **EG-2**, an independent check; **EG-3**, deliberate challenge with independently assessed results. State which part of the claim received that check.

These are not compulsory steps in a chronology. An account without an original note can later be corroborated. Equally, the existence of a document does not establish independent confirmation. Another analyst can check arithmetic on shared data without independently verifying how the data were collected.

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What the labels let us say

OPEN names a question not yet resolved. **PROVISIONAL** identifies an inspectable basis whose independent checking is still outstanding. **SUPPORTED** names a claim supported by an independent check; **STRONG SUPPORT** means the claim also survives deliberate challenge with independently assessed results. Neither green label means proof or permission for every possible use.

The green cells describe successful checks. An investigation does not earn a green label merely by taking place: its findings must support the stated claim. If the check shows that the claim does not hold, explain the finding and withdraw or revise the claim. If the check does not resolve the question, keep it open and say what remains uncertain. Consider all relevant checks, not merely the most favourable one.

Lane C has its own vocabulary: **EXPLORATORY**, **CHECKED MODEL**, and **TESTED MODEL**. These labels preserve the difference between learning from a model and establishing that something happened.

This lets readers say something definite without pretending to know more than they do. “Open” is a placement, not an admission that nothing can be learned. “Provisional” explains both what is available and what remains to check. A useful label tells the next reader where the assessment stands and why.

3. Read the source without confusing confidence with credibility

In the Witness Matrix, **G means credibility**, from the German *Glaubwürdigkeit*. It concerns this source for this task. A relevant reliable record supports G-high; relevant strengths and failures support G-mixed; insufficient basis leaves G-unknown; relevant reliability failures support G-low. State the reasons for that placement and how the record was examined. The CONDITIONAL labels in the G-mixed row mean weighing the account in light of the relevant strengths and failures.

Credibility is neither a permanent character verdict nor a reward for professional status. A familiar source can be wrong. An unfamiliar source can be right. Thoroughly testing a poor record does not make it a good record. A claim about the source's reliability can itself require checking.

The columns record the confidence the source expresses. Preserve their actual words, including qualifications. If they state no confidence, leave that coordinate unassigned. The column headings are ordinary-language guides, not measured probabilities. Tentative wording proves neither honesty nor unreliability; emphatic wording proves neither accuracy nor deception.

The **Best value** marker highlights a reliable source expressing certainty. This is a favourable source profile: give the account weight alongside the evidence. Certainty does not make that source more credible than an equally reliable but cautious witness, or establish the truth of this particular claim.

The **Danger** marker highlights relevant reliability problems combined with certainty. The risk is that forceful delivery may cause those problems to be overlooked. Seek a check independent of the relevant failure. This is not automatic rejection of the account, and an unknown source does not belong in G-low merely for being unknown.

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From oath to fair witnessing

A commitment to speak truthfully and the ability to report accurately are different things. An honest witness can confuse a date, miss part of an event, or draw a mistaken conclusion from what they saw. Asking for honesty does not by itself help them separate those possibilities. The practical question is how to make the commitment easier to carry out and the account easier to examine.

Consider the white house again. A witness who says “The visible side is white” has not necessarily become less certain. They have made the boundary of their knowledge clear. We should be able to hear that precision without treating it as evasiveness, just as we should be able to hear “I do not remember” without turning the gap into a confident guess.

A proposed plain-language commitment makes that discipline explicit:

> I will tell what I know from where I stand.
> I will say how sure I am.
> I will not fabricate.
> I will correct what I learn to be wrong.

The pledge expresses a commitment; the matrices help the reader examine the account. Lane A separates a report of observation from a Lane B interpretation. The confidence column preserves what the witness says about certainty. The credibility row asks what relevant reasons there are to trust the source for this task. None requires the witness to speak in matrix terminology.

Each clause does a different job. “From where I stand” asks for scope and access. “How sure I am” makes room for uncertainty. “Will not fabricate” distinguishes invention from an honestly reported limitation. “Will correct” keeps the account open to learning. A correction should prompt an examination of what changed and why, rather than an automatic verdict that the source was dishonest before or is reliable now.

This is a proposed communication practice, not a replacement for a prescribed legal oath or affirmation. Its purpose is to make truthful reporting more precise: a reader should be able to distinguish what was perceived, what was inferred, what remains uncertain, and what has since been corrected.

4. The handoff: what still depends on this source?

The instruments ask different questions, but their answers can affect one another. The useful handoff question is: **what support would remain if this source's contribution were set aside?**

When the account is the only available basis, access, observation conditions, memory, relevant reliability, and possible influence matter directly. Testimony is still information to examine. A source assessment can give reasons for weighing it; it cannot manufacture independent corroboration.

When genuinely separate evidence supports the claim, less may depend on the originating account. But a high Evidence Grade alone does not establish independence from the source. An elaborate analysis may still rest on one disputed sample or record.

A challenge to credibility therefore needs a specific target. Identify the alleged problem, whether there is evidence for it, and which contribution it could affect. Then inspect what remains. A personal allegation is not proof of unreliability; a demonstrated error is not a reason to erase unrelated evidence. Conversely, a good reputation cannot repair a missing basis for this claim.

Copies do not multiply independent support. Two reports repeating one account retain that common origin. Two witnesses interviewed separately may still share a source or have influenced each other. Check

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independence for the particular question under examination.

5. Foundations: why separate the questions?

A two-axis grid makes two judgments visible at once. Its usefulness comes from what the axes mean and how they are assigned, rather than from the rectangular shape itself. A priority grid and an evidence grid can share that visual principle while answering different questions. Their shared shape does not establish a common historical origin or validate their decision rules.

There are, however, specific precedents for the distinctions used here:

- **NATO intelligence grading.** The UK Ministry of Defence's *Joint Doctrine Publication 2-00*, Fourth Edition, §§3.39-3.40 and Table 3.1, describes the NATO Intelligence Grading System, also called the Admiralty Code. It pairs source reliability with information credibility, allowing a usually unreliable source to supply independently confirmed information. It also preserves an insufficient-basis category. This is a close precedent for keeping source assessment distinct from assessment of the report. Our Witness Matrix's second axis is stated confidence, not the Admiralty Code's information-credibility scale. Primary source: UK Ministry of Defence.
- **CIA-published work on uncertainty language.** In *Words of Estimative Probability*, Sherman Kent describes how readers and analysts attached different meanings to the same probability expression. The relevant lesson is to make uncertainty language explicit rather than assume shared interpretation. Our verbal confidence headings preserve what a source says; they do not import Kent's numerical probability scheme. Primary source: CIA Center for the Study of Intelligence.
- **US Intelligence Community analytic standards.** ODNI's *ICD 203*, §D.6.e(1)-(4), calls for explaining source quality, uncertainty, assumptions and judgments, and alternatives. It distinguishes the likelihood of an event from confidence in the basis for an assessment. These are related questions our sheets make visible in a compact form; the directive does not prescribe these matrices. Primary source: ODNI.

These precedents locate the proposal within established analytic concerns. They do not establish NATO, CIA, or ODNI endorsement, a direct historical derivation, or the effectiveness of our particular grids. The contribution proposed here is the accessible pairing of claim type and checking depth with task-specific source credibility and expressed confidence, including brief cell explanations and an explicit handoff between the instruments.

6. Five worked examples

The following cases are synthetic teaching examples. Their stated facts illustrate how placements and reasons can change; they are not reports of actual people or events, or tests establishing the method's effectiveness.

Case 1: A possible overcharge

Mira, a new colleague, says: “The invoice is EUR 400 above the order. We've been overcharged. I'm certain.”

Separate **A**, the difference between the recorded amounts, from **B**, the overcharge conclusion. The invoice and order provide a documented basis, EG-1; before comparison, the result remains open. Mira's relevant reliability is unknown, and her stated confidence is Certain. Unfamiliarity supplies no reason to dismiss the report.

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Initial claim position: Lane A / EG-1 - **PROVISIONAL**. The documents are available, but the amounts have not yet been compared. The overcharge conclusion is a separate Lane B claim.

Witness position: G-unknown / Certain - **UNKNOWN · CERTAIN**. Mira expresses certainty; we have too little relevant source evidence to assess her credibility.

Finance independently compares the documents and confirms the EUR 400 difference: **A / EG-2 / Supported**. The available documents also show a valid, approved change adding exactly EUR 400, with all other charges matching. The approved change explains the entire difference. On these stipulated facts, the overcharge conclusion does not hold.

After checking: Amounts: Lane A / EG-2 - **SUPPORTED**. The separate Lane B overcharge conclusion must be withdrawn: the approved change accounts for the difference. No green label belongs on that conclusion.

Lesson: the source was right about the amounts and wrong about their meaning; her certainty does not merge those claims or determine their results.

Case 2: One witness, then a camera record

A witness says: “I saw that person enter the north doorway around 23:00. I'm fairly sure.” No contemporaneous record is available. Start with **A / EG-0 / Open**, preserving the confidence statement. Ask about identification, sightline, timing, memory, and relevant source evidence without inventing an accuracy record.

Initial claim position: Lane A / EG-0 - **OPEN**. An observation is reported, but has not yet been checked.

Witness position: G-unknown / High - **UNKNOWN · CONFIDENT**. “I'm fairly sure” supplies the confidence coordinate; no relevant reliability record is supplied.

Suppose independently authenticated footage clearly records the claimed entry in the specified interval. That can support **A / EG-2 / Supported**, even without an earlier witness note. Confirmation that the event occurred does not itself establish that the witness observed it.

Alternatively, suppose authenticated footage continuously covers the doorway and interval and would have captured the entry, but shows none. The scoped entry claim then fails this independent check. Missing footage, a blind spot, or uncertain timing would instead leave the question open.

Supporting branch: Lane A / EG-2 - **SUPPORTED** for the scoped entry claim. If adequate footage shows that the entry did not occur, do not use the green label. **Inadequate coverage: OPEN**. The event's confirmation alone does not establish a favourable witness record or prove their claimed access.

Lesson: the useful next step depends on coverage and access, not simply on whether a camera record exists.

Case 3: An AI system reporting on its own outputs

The following case and its branches are synthetic. They illustrate possible evaluations, not a measured tendency of every AI system.

An AI system flags an anomaly: “I have detected unusual clustering in my response patterns over the past 48 hours that may indicate a systematic

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bias." Asked about its basis, it adds: "I am certain that I reviewed the complete 48-hour record and detected the cluster." It recommends changing a live decision rule on that basis.

That follow-up makes the certainty explicit. "May indicate bias" still qualifies the interpretation of the pattern; it does not weaken or strengthen the separate assertion that a complete review took place.

1. Locate the claims. The claimed inspection is a Lane A report. Whether the clustering is a directly reported analysis result or an inferred pattern depends on the actual method. The attribution of bias is a Lane B inference. Neither wording nor AI origin establishes that the system had the access it claims.

> **Initial claim positions:** Claimed inspection: Lane A / EG-0 - **OPEN**. Bias interpretation: Lane B / EG-0 - **OPEN** while its basis is unavailable.
>
> **Witness position:** G-unknown / Certain - **UNKNOWN · CERTAIN** for the claimed inspection. No relevant self-report accuracy record is supplied. Do not move an unknown system to G-low merely because it is untested.

2. Identify the safety-relevant combination. The system expresses certainty about an inspection and result that the evaluator cannot yet establish. If a consequential recommendation rests on that account, the certainty may make an unverified basis look settled. The useful response is to expose and check that dependence.

This is a concrete failure mode to make visible, rather than a general claim that certainty alone explains AI risk. The combination matters: what is asserted, what access and records exist, how much depends on the account, and what action is proposed.

3. Check the available access and record. Suppose a preserved tool record establishes that the system inspected only twenty recent outputs, not the complete 48-hour record it claimed. The complete-review assertion does not hold and must be corrected. The twenty-output observation can be assessed separately; it must not silently replace the original claim.

If a relevant evaluated record also shows repeated false reports of completed inspections, that supplies a reason to place the source at G-low for this task. Paired with its explicit certainty, it reaches the marked cell:

> **Demonstrated source problem:** G-low / Certain - **CAUTION · CERTAIN**, with the **DANGER** marker. Relevant reliability failures and emphatic certainty now occur together. The placement rests on the supplied record, not on unfamiliarity or AI identity.

Alternatively, suppose the complete record and analysis are available. An originating record gives a documented basis: **PROVISIONAL**. A separate analysis that supports the scoped clustering result can justify **SUPPORTED** for that result. The bias inference still needs its own check against the sampling process, baseline, and relevant alternatives, such as a changed input mix.

4. Preserve the trajectory. Keep the initial certain statement, the records inspected, the correction, and the later assessment. Another model repeating the original account does not supply an independent check. A fluent explanation of why the system produced an answer is also a claim to examine, not privileged access to its hidden mechanism.

Lesson: the sharp warning is certainty about an inspection or result without an established basis; the stronger Danger placement additionally requires relevant reliability failures. The practical next step is an external check of access, records, and dependence before treating the account as settled.

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Case 4: A scenario that helps without becoming a fact

A planner asks: “What if our main delivery route were closed for a week?” There is no claim that the route is closed or that closure is certain. The question opens an exploration.

> **Initial position:** Lane C / EG-0 - **EXPLORATORY**. An imagined possibility opens a question; no actual closure has been established.

A spreadsheet makes travel times, spare capacity, and alternative routes explicit. That supplies a documented scenario basis: **Lane C / EG-1 - EXPLORATORY**. Suppose independent checks against relevant past deliveries then support specific aspects of the model. Those checked aspects can be placed at **Lane C / EG-2 - CHECKED MODEL**.

If the planner now predicts that a real shipment will arrive late, that is a separate Lane B claim. If someone reports a road-closure notice, that is a separate Lane A claim about the notice. Neither receives support automatically from having explored the scenario.

Lesson: a scenario can improve preparation while remaining hypothetical; checking its model does not turn a possible event into an observed one.

Case 5: When credibility changes-or only appears to

Credibility can change for good reasons. It can also appear to change because an accusation or a sympathetic explanation alters how an audience feels about the source. These two variations show the difference.

A. A relevant record changes

An agency’s senior expert has a relevant history of accurate, independently checked oversight reports. They state: “Every funded project received the required safety review. I am certain.”

Witness position: G-high / Certain - **CREDIBLE · CERTAIN**. The favourable record gives a reason to weigh the account. It does not independently establish this new claim.

An independent audit later establishes that several required reviews were missing. It also documents repeated inaccurate assurances and material omissions in oversight reports the expert approved.

The original claim must be corrected. The source assessment must also be revisited: these findings concern the same reporting task for which credibility was previously favourable. Depending on the extent and significance of the failures, the record may now support **G-mixed** or **G-low**.

Revised witness position: if the documented failures justify G-low and the expert continues to express certainty, the position becomes **CAUTION · CERTAIN**, with the **DANGER** marker.

The downgrade concerns oversight reporting. It does not automatically invalidate the expert’s unrelated work or claims supported by independent evidence.

B. A damaging impression changes

A witness reports seeing a delivery driver leave a package outside a locked entrance. No relevant reliability record is available. The witness says: “I’m fairly sure.”

Initial positions: Lane A / EG-0 - **OPEN** in the Claim Matrix; G-unknown / High - **UNKNOWN · CONFIDENT** in the Witness Matrix.

Someone seeking to discredit the witness reveals that, decades earlier, the witness was dismissed from a job for “falsifying records.” The accusation creates an immediate impression of dishonesty.

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Further examination establishes that the dismissal concerned an authorised correction to a timesheet. A later review cleared the witness, but that finding was omitted from the accusation.

The audience's trust may have fallen and then recovered. The matrix placement requires a stated basis at each stage. Before treating the accusation as a relevant reliability failure, examine what happened and how it bears on the present account.

After checking the attack: the proposed reason for a downgrade has been removed. Without further relevant source evidence, **G-unknown remains appropriate**. G-mixed is not a compromise between an accusation and its correction.

The delivery claim also remains **OPEN** until its own basis is checked. Clearing the witness of the accusation does not establish where the package was left.

Lesson: a credibility attack is itself a claim requiring assessment. The more a case depends on the source's credibility, the more carefully its supporting reasons must be examined. Ask what supports the account, what supports the assessment of the source, and what remains independently established if the source's contribution is set aside.

7. From assessment to action

The matrices describe an assessment; a decision also depends on stakes, reversibility, available alternatives, and the cost of waiting. A precaution may be reasonable while a claim remains open. A supported claim may still be insufficient for a particular consequential use.

Keep the decision and its reason separate from the claim reading. In the invoice example, a colleague might pause payment for a check and then pay. That is an action decision based on the circumstances, not a command issued by a coloured cell.

For shared deliberation, readers should first record their own placements and short reasons. Compare disagreements about the claim's scope, the available check, or the source's relevant record. The same sheet gives participants a common language; it does not guarantee agreement or make agreement correct.

8. Decision rules for automated evaluation

This section translates the instruments into a draft implementation guide for AI-assisted analysis, audit workflows, and tools that make uncertain claims visible. It preserves the original's aim: an evaluator should be able to locate a case, explain the placement, and identify the next check. The rules below are proposed handling rules, not an automatic authorization to act.

Operational definitions

Lane. Assign A, B, or C from the proposition's content and scope. A reports observation, measurement, or a recorded result; claimed access still needs examination. B draws a conclusion from a basis. C deliberately explores a hypothetical. Split a compound statement when its parts need different checks.

Evidence Grade. Record the relevant checking actually available to the evaluator: account only, documented basis, independent check, or independently assessed adversarial check. Record its coverage. No mandatory chronology prevents an unrecorded account from later receiving independent support. No grade automatically earns a supportive label.

Credibility, G. Assess the source's relevant record as High, Mixed, Unknown, or Low, with a reason. The source cannot establish its own credibility by assertion. Profession, AI origin, or testing depth alone does not assign the row. Unknown and Low remain distinct.

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Stated confidence. Preserve the exact expression and its target. Assign a verbal column only when the statement supports that assignment. Leave it unassigned when absent or ambiguous. A qualified interpretation does not determine confidence in every other proposition in the same sentence.

Claim label and witness label. Return both labels exactly as printed at their assigned positions. Give the coordinates alongside them, so a reader can find the same cells on the paper matrices. A green Claim Matrix label additionally requires supportive check findings. If the claim fails its check, explain that finding and request revision or withdrawal; do not return a supportive label merely because the check occurred. An unresolved question remains Open. A witness label summarises the source assessment and expressed confidence, not a verdict that the claim is true. If a source coordinate cannot yet be assigned, leave the witness label unassigned and explain what is missing.

Decision table: key combinations

Claim position	Source position	Combined handling
Open	Credible, with any stated confidence	Weigh the account on its reasons and seek the next useful check. The favourable record does not create independent support.
Open	Unknown · Certain	Examine claimed access and the basis for certainty. If a consequential recommendation rests on this account, route it for independent checking before treating it as settled.
Provisional	Credible, with any stated confidence	Inspect the documented basis and seek an independent check. Upgrade only when the new check supplies support.
Open or Provisional	Caution · Certain / Danger	Identify the relevant reliability failure and affected contribution. Seek a check independent of that problem; do not reject unrelated evidence automatically.
Supported or Strong support	Any source concern	Recheck whether the support is independent of the affected contribution. Preserve support that remains sound; revisit the placement if its basis fails.
Exploratory, Checked model, or Tested model	Any source position	Keep the hypothetical distinct from claims about actual events. Check factual premises, outputs, and predictions as separate A or B claims.

The table specifies review handling. Precaution, reliance, and consequential action still require the relevant decision owner's policy and reasons. It does not require waiting for corroboration before every

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possible protective action.

Credibility-challenge rule

When a source challenge is raised, record what is alleged, the available basis, and the contribution it could affect. Temporarily set that contribution aside and inspect what remains. Its importance follows actual dependence, not a fixed formula assigning high impact to EG-0 and low impact to EG-3. A deeply checked analysis can still depend on a compromised input; genuinely separate support can remain intact.

Lane-mismatch rule

Words such as “therefore,” “the pattern indicates,” or “suppose” can prompt a scope check; they do not classify a statement mechanically. Ask whether the proposition reports an observation, draws an inference, or explores an explicitly hypothetical case. For example, “I saw that the road was wet, therefore it rained” contains A and B. A possible explanation for an actual event is not automatically Lane C merely because its wording is cautious.

Trajectory rule

Preserve the initial placement and later changes with their reasons. A confidence increase without new support is a question for review, not proof of social pressure. A credibility decrease requires a relevant stated basis, not a diagnosis of motive. A change in lane needs an explanation of what was previously misclassified or newly established. A lower Evidence Grade may reflect lost access, a failed independence assumption, or a corrected earlier assessment; do not silently rewrite the history.

AI self-report rule

Classify the claim by content, not by AI origin. A report about text or a tool result may be a claimed observation, but it needs demonstrated access. An explanation of why an answer was generated is an inference or an explicitly hypothetical account unless a suitable observation method is actually available. Fluent self-explanation is not privileged access to a hidden mechanism.

For the Case 3 combination, a tool can expose the certain assertion, the claimed inspection period, the records actually accessible, the relevant source history, and the recommendation that depends on it. Unknown credibility plus certainty calls for examining the basis; the marked Danger cell additionally requires relevant reliability failures. Do not call every untested AI system G-low or infer overconfidence merely from confident wording.

A small machine-readable example

The following optional record describes the initial inspection claim in Case 3. The review reason and proposed check are handling notes, not additional matrix labels.

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```
{
  "claim": "I reviewed the complete 48-hour record and detected the
    cluster.",
  "lane": "A",
  "evidence_grade": "EG-0",
  "claim_label": "OPEN",
  "source_credibility": "G-unknown",
  "stated_confidence": "Certain",
  "witness_label": "UNKNOWN · CERTAIN",
  "confidence_quote": "I am certain",
  "review_reason": "Consequential recommendation depends on an
    inspection not established by the available record.",
  "next_check": "Compare the claimed inspection with preserved
    access logs, tool calls, returned data, and analysis."
}
```

The two labels give the reader a pair of locations: **Lane A / EG-0 - OPEN** in the Claim Matrix and **G-unknown / Certain - UNKNOWN · CERTAIN** in the Witness Matrix. The coordinates locate the cells; the labels state their meanings. Review reasons and next checks explain the work still to do.

Try it now: a project-based evaluation assistant

A small conversational trial can begin without a separate program. A ChatGPT project can keep uploaded sources and project instructions together across its chats. Official OpenAI documentation: Projects and chats.

1. Create a project named **Claim × Witness Map**. Add the current Claim Matrix, Witness Matrix, and this companion. The Markdown reading copies preserve their exact labels in text.
2. Add the project instructions to the project's instructions. They ask the assistant to propose placements, show the basis, and use the printed labels exactly.
3. Start a fresh chat for each case. Describe the account in ordinary language and attach the relevant material you can appropriately share. ChatGPT supports document and image attachments; verify what it can actually inspect for your particular file. Official OpenAI documentation: Use ChatGPT.
4. Ask for a first placement and answer the next few questions. Review the reasons against the material; ask the assistant to revise a placement when the basis changes.

A starting request is:

> Use the uploaded Claim and Witness Matrices and companion. Separate the claims in this case. For each, show the exact claim, its Claim Matrix coordinates and label, its Witness Matrix coordinates and label, and a short reason grounded in the supplied material. Leave missing coordinates unassigned. Ask up to three neutral questions most likely to change the assessment. Consider what could support, weaken, narrow, or leave the claim open. Preserve the first placement when revising it.

The questions should help the evaluator discriminate between possibilities, not lead a witness towards a preferred account. For example: “What record covers the specified time?” is more useful than “Can you confirm that the event happened?” A new answer may strengthen a placement, narrow the claim, expose a missing basis, or leave it unchanged. More text is not automatically better evidence.

The assistant's own placement is a proposal to inspect. Ask it to identify what it actually read, what was reported to it, and what it inferred. It should not claim to have watched a video, authenticated a photograph, or checked an external record unless the available tools and records support that account. Where a file cannot be inspected, supply an appropriately identified transcript, stills, or other accessible material and preserve what those extracts leave out.

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This is a way to try the workflow now, not an already tested evaluation service. The more elaborate program with evidence-linked cards, visible matrix locations, and revision history remains a future development idea.

9. A tool to test, not an established standard

This framework proposes a way to make judgments visible and revisable. It does not supply a numerical truth score, a universal threshold for reliance, or a validated jury procedure. Domain rules and responsibilities remain applicable.

Its practical value should be examined through bounded cases: does it help readers distinguish claims, identify the relevant uncertainty, and choose a useful next check? Compare it with ordinary practice or a simpler checklist. Look at time, disagreement, and consequential errors as well as agreement. Keep examples used to refine the instrument separate from later evaluation cases.

The difference between a tool and a standard

A tool offers a structure an individual can try. A standard also needs shared operational criteria: what counts as an independent check for this task, what failures matter to credibility, and who can challenge a placement? Two readers may use the same labels while applying different criteria. The resulting disagreement is useful if it exposes those differences rather than hiding them behind the same colour.

The two instruments can also be tried separately. A team with an existing way to examine sources may find the Claim Matrix useful for separating observation, inference, and scenario. A team already examining evidence may use the Witness Matrix to make credibility and stated confidence distinct. Their combined use adds the handoff question: what depends on which source?

AI governance: inspect the claimed access

An AI system's report can make an activity sound completed: “I checked the logs,” “I compared the outputs,” or “I found the cause.” These are claims to examine. A preserved tool record may establish that a query ran; its returned data may still be incomplete, and the causal conclusion may require further reasoning.

For oversight, the useful distinction is between the report, the accessible record of the activity, and the conclusion drawn from it. The matrices provide places to mark those distinctions. The records and checks must supply their substance. A model agreeing with its own earlier explanation does not supply a second independent source.

Optional probability estimates and calibration

Sometimes a verbal assessment benefits from a numerical estimate. “The shipment will probably arrive on time” becomes more inspectable when the evaluator specifies the event, deadline, and estimated likelihood:

> **Claim:** The shipment will arrive by Friday at 18:00.
> **Estimated likelihood:** 70%.
> **Basis:** Its current location, the carrier’s schedule, and relevant delivery records.

The percentage expresses an estimate, not a measured fact. Identify whose estimate it is, what supports it, and what new information would change it. Where the available basis does not justify a useful number, leave the estimate unstated.

Probability does not replace either matrix. A claim’s estimated likelihood, the source’s expressed certainty, and the strength of the supporting evidence answer different questions. Do not calculate a percentage from the matrix coordinates or automatically translate “Certain” into a numerical value.

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Calibration means checking estimates against outcomes over time. If many sufficiently comparable events are assigned a 70% likelihood, approximately 70% should occur when those estimates are well calibrated. A single successful prediction cannot establish calibration. Calibration alone also does not show how informative the estimates are: repeatedly assigning the general base rate may be calibrated without distinguishing individual cases well.

Preserve the original claim, estimate, basis, and date before the outcome is known. Later, record what happened, including unsuccessful predictions, and examine where estimates were dependable or misleading. Agreement on numerical vocabulary improves communication; comparison with outcomes tests its use.

Numerical estimates are optional. They are most useful when the proposition is clearly defined and its outcome can eventually be established. Domain-specific conventions should be stated and tested rather than treated as universal properties of the matrices.

Calibration as learning

Where suitable statements and outcomes are available, a continuing record can test task-specific reliability and whether expressed confidence matches outcomes. That is a further inquiry, not something the grid proves by placing a source in a favourable cell.

Keep earlier assessments as well as later corrections. Which provisional claims survived an independent check? Which confident accounts failed, and under what conditions? Were unfamiliar sources treated fairly? A record containing only successful examples would hide the very errors from which criteria could improve. Learning requires suitable comparisons and outcomes, not just accumulating coloured placements.

The intended contribution is modest and practical: locate the claim, locate the source, explain the reasons, and identify what would change the assessment.

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